



UPA LEADERS WITH PRESIDENT PRATIBHA PATIL DURING THE FORMATION OF THE GOVERNMENT

Crisis and COMPROMISE

These are not the milestones that Manmohan would want as UPA-II completes its first year

The Cut Motions

The Government pulled off a coup by getting RJD, SP and BSP to thwart the BJP and Left-sponsored cut motions. But allegations of dilution in CBI cases erode moral high ground.

IPL Scandal

Manmohan axed a Congress minister facing allegations of ministerial impropriety but had to defend the NCP and rule out the demand for a Joint Parliamentary Committee on the IPL.

Insurance and Banking Reforms

The Government has promised reforms in insurance and banking but cannot move on new legislation because Mamata is the new Left.

Women's Reservation Bill

While Sonia is keen to push this through the Lok Sabha, this could become a casualty of the Yadav duo's support on the cut motions.

Disinvestment

The Government wants to set an ambitious disinvestment target. But it has not been able to push PSU disinvestment in either Tamil Nadu or West Bengal.

Price Rise

Rising food prices united the entire Opposition. Even the UPA's secular allies—RJD, SP and the JD(s)—joined hands with the Left and BJP. But the prime minister had to follow the dictum of collective responsibility and defend Sharad Pawar.

Land Acquisition & Resettlement Policy

India badly needs a policy to enable industry and infrastructure projects to acquire land by facilitating rehabilitation of oustees. But this has been thwarted by Mamata's opposition to land acquisition.

Cabinet Composition

The Prime Minister had indicated his view on the inclusion of ministers from coalition partners NCP and DMK but had to eventually accept their diktat.

comfortable majority. And it is amply clear that this was a planned win, not one handed over to them on a platter of 'human errors'?

Few believe Soren when he claims that he pressed the red button (indicating that he was voting against the BJP's motion) because of human error. Instead, his claims of innocence only add to the myth of the Machiavellian Congress. Truth be told, Soren is a past master of "vote situations" having first made headlines during the Narasimha Rao government's first brush with challenge in 1993. Earlier in the day, before he sauntered into Parliament and played his Lok Sabha MP card (despite being the Jharkhand chief minister he still retains his membership of the Lower House) he had already had a fruitful conversation with Keshav Rao, the Congress general secretary in charge of Jharkhand. Which is perhaps why he did not look particularly perturbed when the BJP withdrew support from his state government the very next day. Again, Mayawati may have spent 17 minutes of her 18-minute press conference attacking the Congress party's economic policies but at the last minute she did announce her support. An angry BJP is already connecting the dots. "Suddenly in April 2010, a statement is made before the Supreme Court seeking to dilute the case of disproportionate assets against Mayawati when her support is required in the Cut Motion in the Lok Sabha," said Arun Jaitley while